

Dementia Care & Caregiver Support

Learner guide | SWP-011 | School of Gerontology & Aging Services

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Dementia Care & Caregiver Support. By the end of the course, you should be able to apply person-centred approaches to dementia support and caregiver wellbeing.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Apply person-centred approaches to dementia support and caregiver wellbeing.
- Apply the key ideas from Understanding dementia.
- Apply the key ideas from Daily support and responsive care.
- Apply the key ideas from Caregiver support.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Understanding dementia	common presentations, communication, stigma, and preserving identity	10 to 15 minutes
2. Daily support and responsive care	environment, routines, distress behaviours, consent, and family partnership	10 to 15 minutes
3. Caregiver support	burden, respite, education, crisis planning, and referral	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Understanding dementia

This module focuses on common presentations, communication, stigma, and preserving identity. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Common presentations
- Communication
- Stigma
- Preserving identity

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of understanding dementia in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of common presentations, communication, stigma, and preserving identity. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through understanding dementia safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Daily support and responsive care

This module focuses on environment, routines, distress behaviours, consent, and family partnership. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Environment
- Routines
- Distress behaviours
- Consent
- Family partnership

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of daily support and responsive care in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of environment, routines, distress behaviours, consent, and family partnership. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through daily support and responsive care safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Caregiver support

This module focuses on burden, respite, education, crisis planning, and referral. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Burden
- Respite
- Education
- Crisis planning
- Referral

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of caregiver support in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of burden, respite, education, crisis planning, and referral. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through caregiver support safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: person-centred care.
- Review the distinction between: communication.
- Review the distinction between: caregiver supports.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.